

Product Management Launchpad — Case Study



BookMyShow: Building Entertainment Discovery

ProjectBookMyShow: Building Entertainment Discovery

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A seven-step product case study, from market research through to risks and trade-offs.

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Why India Browses but Doesn't Book

Why discovery-led users explore entertainment on BookMyShow but don't complete a booking — and where competitors capture them instead.

BookMyShow Product Case Study · July 2026 · Confidential · Survey n=24
Market · Research · Personas · Format Gap · Problem · Funnel · Barrier · Impact · Brainstorm · RICE · Top 2 · Trade-offs · Journey Map · PRD · Scope · Stories · Metrics · Rollout · Rationale · Launch · Growth Loop · Business Impact · Cohorts · North Star · Guardrails · Events · Risks · Constraints

STEP 1

Market & User Research

01

About BookMyShow

BookMyShow (Bigtree Entertainment) is India's dominant online entertainment ticketing platform. Since 2007 it has become the default way the country books **movies**, and increasingly **live events, sports and plays**, across 650+ towns and cities. Nobody disputes that scale. What's worth digging into is what it's built on: almost all of it comes down to one behaviour, **high-intent transactions**. People show up already knowing what they want, book it, and leave. This report is about the other half of the market — the **discovery-led users who browse but never book**.

SCALE & REACH

50M+ App downloads	15M+ Tickets / month	30M+ Customers	650+ Towns & cities	5,000+ Screens
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FY25 FINANCIALS (₹ CRORE)

₹1,869 Cr Total income	₹192 Cr Net profit (consol.)	₹828 Cr Online ticketing rev.	₹756 Cr Live events rev.
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WHY THIS MATTERS

Live events revenue (₹756 Cr) has grown to nearly match core online ticketing (₹828 Cr). That's a sign the **"going-out" decision, not just the movie ticket, is becoming the real battleground**. BookMyShow wins the transaction, but it barely shows up in the discovery moment that leads up to it.

02

User Research

Primary research combined a **user survey (n=24, 25-34 skew)** with app-review mining and a competitive teardown to understand what drives a discovery-led booking, and what gets in the way of one. Given the sample size, we're treating the findings as directional, not conclusive.

KEY SURVEY FINDINGS

50% Arrive discovery-led	83% Decide off-platform	62.5% Browse → no booking	87.5% Need reviews / trailers
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RESEARCH QUESTIONS

1	When users open BMS without a fixed choice , what are they actually trying to decide?
2	At what point do discovery-led users drop off or leave the app — and where do they go instead?
3	What information do users need to feel confident booking something unfamiliar ?
4	How do groups decide on and commit to a plan, and where does that process break down?
5	Which competing products or paths do users prefer for discovery, and why?
6	What would make BookMyShow a first stop for deciding — not just for booking something already chosen?

RESEARCH PLAN

Segments High-intent BMS bookers · Discovery-led browsers (25-34, urban) · Group planners (2-6 person outings) · Users of competing paths (District, Instagram, Insider)	Methods Survey — primary, 24 responses · App-review mining (store & feature signals) · Competitive teardown of rival flows · Informal interviews & observation
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50% arrive discovery-led	83% decide off-platform	62.5% browse → no booking	87.5% need reviews / trailers
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03

Competitive Analysis

Users increasingly discover entertainment **outside** ticketing apps — on Instagram, YouTube, Google and in WhatsApp groups. And even among the ticketing players, discovery, comparison and group planning are handled in pretty different ways.

Dimension	BookMyShow	Zomato District	Paytm Insider
Discovery	Rigid category grids; purely transactional.	Curated mood/vibe feed layered on an interactive map.	Chronological culture calendar + artist-following.
Comparison	Within-category only; price shown at checkout.	Cross-category (dinner + movie vs. concert) + value loops.	Transparent tiered pricing (early-bird vs. general).
Group planning	Post-purchase ticket transfer only.	Bill splitting + shared map pins (pre-purchase).	Drops out to external chats.
Sports & Play	Spectate / venue-entry tickets.	Pick a sport → book the actual court or turf.	Not a focus.

Curation	One endless catalogue; same for everyone.	Vibe rails, near-you, "forgotten favourites."	Editorial, niche & community-led.
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Condensed view. The full competitive analysis (market share, revenue, discovery pipeline, feature face-off) is attached as a separate document.

04 Discovery Personas

Four archetypes came out of this: one the current format already fits, and three who feel the gap in different ways. Listed from most-served to least.

The Decided Booker ≈ 50% of respondents Book the movie/event they've already chosen, fast. The linear funnel is a feature, not a friction. "BMS is always my first choice."	The Undecided Explorer ≈ 21% — opens the app to decide Find a plan worth leaving the house for — but there's no "help me decide" surface, so they bounce to social. "Front end is boring — District is better."
The Social Coordinator The 2-6 person outing Get the group to agree and actually lock it in before the plan stalls in WhatsApp or the show fills up. "By the time everyone replies, the show's filling up or we've given up."	Validation & Budget Seeker ≈ 17% social-led · budget-anchored Be sure it's worth the money before an unfamiliar booking — so they cross-check reviews, trailers and price elsewhere. "Reviews from real people, side-by-side showing, a map for distance, lock-in price at ₹0."

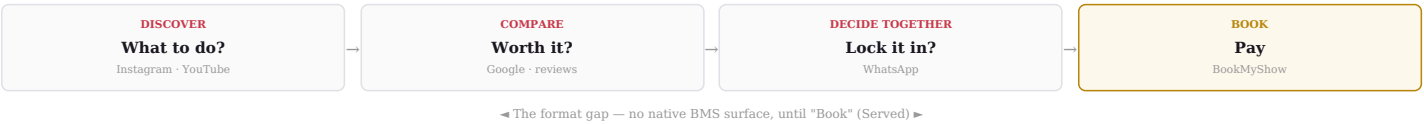
Quotes are verbatim survey responses (lightly cleaned); the Social Coordinator's is representative. Segment sizes are directional, mapped from the Q2 decision-mode split (n=24).

05 Barriers & the Format Gap

TOP ANTICIPATED BARRIERS

The decision happens off-platform Users leave BMS for Instagram, Google and friends to decide what to do — the choice is made before they return.
No side-by-side comparison Prices, timings and locations can't be lined up in one view, so users bounce between screens to compare.
The "is it worth it?" gap Listings don't convey vibe or value, so users won't commit to unfamiliar events without external reviews or trailers.
Group coordination is invisible There's no in-app way to hold a seat or agree on a plan, so coordination dies in WhatsApp before anyone books.
No personalized, situation-aware discovery No "near-you this weekend" surface or combined budget + date + distance filter to match a real going-out plan.

WHERE THE FORMAT GAP LIVES



WHO FEELS IT MOST It's the discovery-led 25-34 majority, and the Social Coordinator feels it worst, because planning a 2-6 person outing on a budget stacks every part of the gap on top of the others. They show up undecided, can't compare or judge value in-app, and can't lock in a plan while the group is still deciding, so they end up finishing the whole job across Instagram, Google and WhatsApp. The Decided Booker (50% of respondents) barely notices any of this — which is exactly why the problem doesn't show up in the revenue.
THE FORMAT GAP, IN ONE LINE BookMyShow has nailed the <i>last mile</i> for people who've already decided. For the other half, who haven't decided yet, there's no road at all.

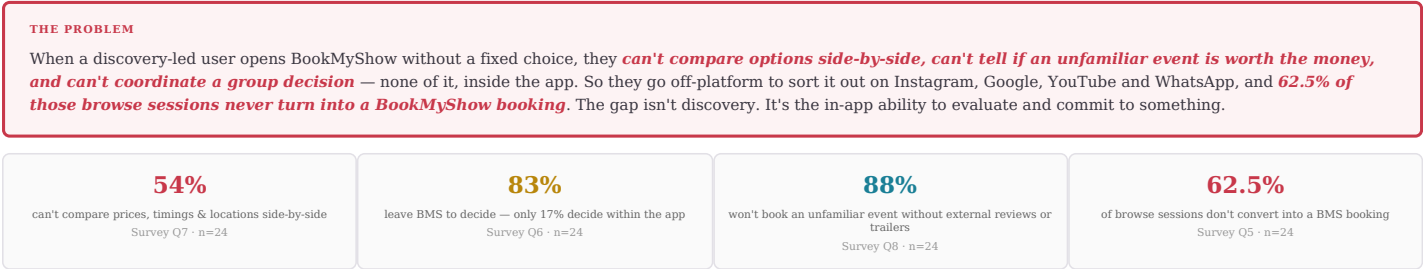
STEP 2

Frame the Problem

06

Refined Problem Statement

Step 1 told us BookMyShow has **no road for the undecided user**. Step 2 gets more specific about where that actually bites: the steepest drop-off isn't at discovery, and it isn't at checkout either. It's at the **comparison and validation layer**, which the app just doesn't have.



SUPPORTING OBSERVATIONS

"Reviews from real people, side-by-side showing, a map for distance, lock-in price at ₹0." Survey Q13 — Validation & Budget Seeker	"Front end is boring — District is better." Survey Q13 — Undecided Explorer
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WHY "COMPARISON" NOT "DISCOVERY"

Users do find things on BMS. 50% browse without a fixed plan (Q4), and listings show up fine in the app. Where it breaks is **one step later**: someone sees three comedy shows on Saturday and has no way to line up price, timing, venue distance and social proof on one screen. That's the moment they leave the app, and once they've left, the booking is anyone's to win.

07

Discovery Funnel Deep-Dive

The journey from "I want to go out" to "booked on BookMyShow" breaks into four stages. The survey data lets us map how many users make it through each one, and more usefully, exactly where they drop off.

Stage 1: Discovery — 100%



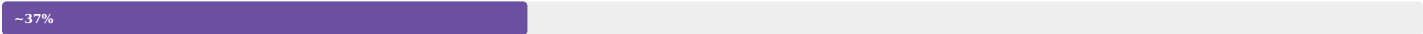
Everyone starts here. 50% already know what they want (Decided Bookers) and skip to Stage 4. The rest are discovery-led — browsing the app, scrolling social, or asking friends.

Stage 2: Comparison — ~83% ▼ 17% drop · flat listings, no curation



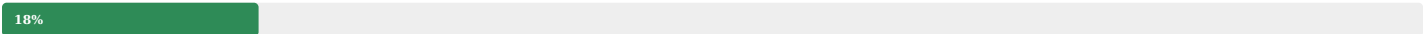
Steepest drop. 83% leave BMS to compare — can't line up options side-by-side (54%), can't read vibe or value (37.5%), can't find reviews without leaving (88%). They go to Instagram, Google, YouTube, or ask around.

Stage 3: Shortlist & Decide — ~37% ▼ 46% drop · decision moves off-platform



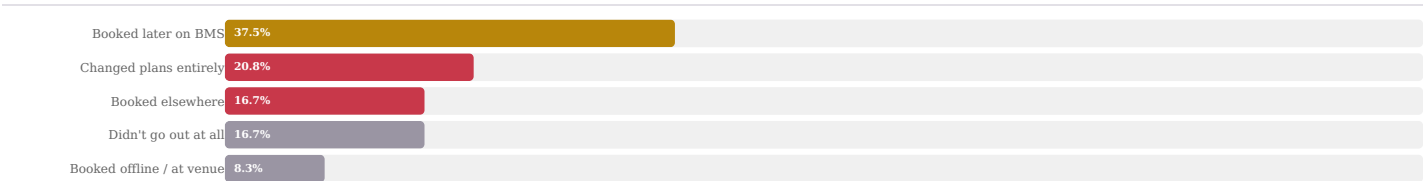
The decision itself happens elsewhere. Friends in person (33%), Instagram creators (29%), Google reviews (25%), YouTube trailers (25%). Group plans stall in WhatsApp with nothing in-app to hold a seat.

Stage 4: Booking — 18% ▼ 19% drop · group stalls, competitor capture



Only 18% of discovery-led sessions convert on BMS. The other 82% go to a competitor, an offline booking, a different plan, or no outing at all.

WHAT HAPPENS TO LEAKED SESSIONS (Q5 · N=24)



62.5% of discovery-led sessions don't convert on BMS. Of those, 25% (booked elsewhere + offline) went to a direct competitor or alternative channel — revenue that was in reach.

WHERE THE STEEPEST DROP-OFF OCCURS

Most of the damage happens between **Stage 2 (Comparison)** and **Stage 3 (Shortlist)** — 83% of discovery-led users leave the app right there. BMS has no tooling for this at all: no side-by-side view, no in-app reviews or trailers, no combined budget/distance/date filter, no way to hold options while checking with friends. The users who do get through this stage tend to come back and book without much trouble — the last-mile transaction is fine. The real problem is getting people past the comparison wall.

08

Primary Barrier

There's more than one friction point here, but one barrier has by far the strongest link to lost bookings — it's the one that kicks off the chain reaction pushing everyone else off-platform.

PRIMARY BARRIER — NO IN-APP COMPARISON AND VALIDATION LAYER

When a discovery-led user finds a few options worth weighing on BookMyShow, they hit a wall: **there's no screen that lines up price, timing, venue distance and social proof side-by-side**. Every listing is its own page. Comparing means bouncing between screens and holding details in your head, or giving up and opening Google, Instagram, or YouTube.

That one barrier sets off a three-step leak. First, the user can't evaluate what's in front of them. Then they leave the app to compare and validate elsewhere. And once they're off-platform, they hit competitor alternatives, stalled group chats, and decision fatigue — which is how 62.5% never make it back to book.

WHY THIS BARRIER, NOT OTHERS

1	Highest citation in the survey. 54.17% picked "can't easily compare prices, timings, and locations side-by-side" as their top difficulty — the single most-selected option in all of Q7.
2	It causes the off-platform exodus. 83% leave the app to decide, not to discover. Instagram (29%), Google (25%), YouTube (25%) and friends (33%) are validation channels here, not discovery ones.

3	It compounds with the "is it worth it?" gap. 37.5% say descriptions lack vibe/value (Q7), and 87.5% need reviews or trailers before an unfamiliar booking (Q8) — two symptoms of the same missing layer.
4	Users named the fix themselves. Top three requested features: personalized weekend suggestions (50%), combined budget/date/distance filter (50%), and side-by-side comparison (33%) — all point at the comparison layer (Q10).

WHAT ABOUT GROUP COORDINATION?

Group coordination is a real pain point — **67% said they'd use in-app group planning** (Q11) and **54% want "Hold my Seat"** (Q12). But it's downstream of the real problem: a group can only coordinate around options it's actually evaluated. Fix comparison and validation first and group planning has something to work with. Fix group planning alone and people are just voting on things they still can't judge. That's the difference between the primary barrier and the amplifier.

09Business Impact

Now let's tie the comparison gap to actual money. The brief's target is moving discovery-led conversion from **18% to 32%**, and here's how the survey data supports that number.

CURRENT STATE 18% Discovery-to-booking conversion. The survey backs it up: only 37.5% of browse sessions eventually convert on BMS (Q5), and of the 50% who arrive discovery-led, a large share leak out through the comparison gap before checkout.	TARGET STATE 32% A 14-point jump, achievable just by keeping users in-app through the comparison stage instead of losing them to external validation. We don't need to manufacture demand — it's already there. We need to stop it leaking out.
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WHERE THE REVENUE LEAKS

₹828 Cr FY25 online ticketing revenue — the base this conversion rate operates on Step 1 · BMS Financials	50% of total sessions are discovery-led (not pre-decided) — the sessions at risk Survey Q2 · n=24	25% of lost sessions go to competitors or offline channels — direct revenue leakage Survey Q5
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THE THREE REVENUE RECOVERY POOLS

The 62.5% of leaked sessions split into three pools, and each traces back to the comparison barrier.

- Pool 1 · Changed plans entirely (20.8%)** — wanted to go out, couldn't settle on anything. A comparison layer that helps them shortlist turns indecision into action.
- Pool 2 · Booked elsewhere or offline (25%)** — did go out, just not through BMS. Keep them in-app through validation and this revenue comes back directly.
- Pool 3 · Didn't go out (16.7%)** — the plan died from friction. Lowering the effort to compare, validate and commit recovers some of these — and grows the market rather than just shifting share.

THE BUSINESS CASE, IN ONE LINE

BookMyShow doesn't have a demand problem. Half its users show up ready to explore. What it has is a *conversion architecture* problem — built for people who've already made up their mind, offering nothing to anyone who hasn't. Closing the comparison gap is the most direct way to move discovery-led conversion from 18% to 32%.

Solution Ideation & Prioritization

10 Solution Brainstorm

Twelve ideas, each mapping to a specific stage in the discovery funnel. The two **shortlisted** ones (★) came out on top on RICE.

Idea	Priority	What it does & what it solves
★ Compare Tray	Shortlisted	Pin 2-3 events to a persistent tray; a swipe reveals side-by-side price, timing, distance, ratings. Solves: can't evaluate options without bouncing between listing pages.
★ Validation Proof Layer	Shortlisted	Embed video highlights, reaction clips, verified reviews (incl. Instagram Reels, YouTube) on event pages. Solves: can't judge if an unfamiliar event is worth the money without leaving.
Smart Filters	High	Combined budget + date + distance filter in one panel. Solves: app shows options outside the user's real-world constraints.
Hold My Seat	High	Lock a seat and price for 12-24h while deciding or coordinating. Removes "it'll sell out" anxiety.
"This Weekend" Feed	High	Personalized, situation-aware "things to do near you this weekend." Solves: undifferentiated catalogue.
Shortlist / Save-for-Later	Medium	Bookmark events, share the list, feed it into Compare Tray. Foundational enabler for comparison.
Group Plan & Vote	Medium	Share a shortlist, vote, book together — replacing the WhatsApp loop.
Commonly Booked Together	Medium	"People who booked this also booked dinner nearby." Cross-category bundling of the outing.
Worth-It Score	Medium	Aggregated value indicator (ratings, price-per-hour, sentiment) — a quick "is this worth it?" signal.
Urgency Signals	Medium	"12 browsing now" · "Only 8 seats left" — real-time social proof and scarcity nudges.
Vibe Browse	Lower	Discover by mood ("date night", "rainy evening") instead of rigid categories.
Curated Weekend Picks	Lower	Editorial + algorithmic shortlists ("Best comedy under ₹500 this weekend").

HOW THESE MAP TO THE FUNNEL

Ideas at the **Discovery stage** get users to something interesting; the **Comparison stage** cluster (Compare Tray, Validation, Smart Filters, Worth-It) helps evaluate what's found; **Shortlist & Lock-in** (Hold My Seat, Group Plan) gets a decision made. The highest-leverage cluster sits right at comparison — exactly where Step 2 showed the steepest 46% drop.

11 RICE Prioritization

Each solution scored using a modified RICE framework, **anchored to survey evidence** rather than gut feel. Treat the scores as directional — the ranking is the point, not the decimals. RICE = (Reach × Impact × Confidence) ÷ Effort.

Solution	R	I	C	E	RICE	Key Evidence
Compare Tray ★	8	3.0	90%	2	10.8	54% #1 pain in Q7 + 33% requested in Q10 · directly fixes primary barrier
Validation Proof Layer ★	10	3.0	100%	3	10.0	88% need validation · Q8 · strongest single signal in entire survey
Smart Filters	8	2.0	90%	1.5	9.6	50% directly requested · Q10 · folded into Compare Tray
Hold My Seat	7	2.0	90%	3	4.2	54% want this · Q12 · downstream of comparison
Shortlist / Save	5	1.0	70%	1	3.5	17% Q10 · low demand but foundational enabler
"This Weekend" Feed	8	2.0	80%	4	3.2	50% Q10 · needs reco engine · targets discovery not comparison
Worth-It Score	6	2.0	60%	2.5	2.9	37.5% Q7 · inferred need, users didn't ask for a score
Group Plan & Vote	7	2.0	75%	4	2.6	67% Q11 · amplifier, not root cause
Urgency Signals	5	1.0	70%	1.5	2.3	29% Q12 · nudge, not structural fix
Commonly Booked Together	5	1.0	70%	2	1.8	33% Q12 · needs booking data pipeline
Curated Weekend Picks	4	1.0	60%	2	1.2	17% Q10 · editorial overhead
Vibe Browse	4	1.0	60%	3	0.8	25% Q7 · new taxonomy required

WHY SMART FILTERS IS NOT SEPARATELY SHORTLISTED

Smart Filters scores 9.6 — low effort, high demand. But a combined budget/date/distance filter is really **a feature of the Compare Tray, not a product on its own**. Ship filters without comparison and people still bounce between isolated listing pages. So Compare Tray is what we shortlisted, and Smart Filters comes along as its front half.

12 Top 2 Solutions

Two solutions, covering three states of one journey: **Narrow → Evaluate → Confirm**. Solution A chains the #1 and #3 RICE scorers into one opt-in flow. Solution B answers the one question that flow can't — **"is it actually worth it?"**

★ SOLUTION A · SMART FILTERS + COMPARE TRAY · RICE 10.8 & 9.6			★ SOLUTION B · RICE 10.0	
Help Me Pick Opt-in flow chaining constraint-setting straight into side-by-side evaluation			Validation Proof Layer In-app reviews, trailers, and audience clips on every event page	
Opt-in, never a gate. A "Help me pick" entry sits on home next to the untouched catalogue, so Decided Bookers (50%) never enter it. A behavioural trigger — bounce between 3+ listings → "Comparing a few? Pin them." Narrow — Smart Filters. Five inputs on one screen, each pre-filled (near me · tonight · any budget), results button live from frame one. Applied filters stay as editable chips above results. Evaluate — Compare Tray. Pin up to 4 events, 3 columns visible, on a category-agnostic spine: all-in price per person, distance + travel time, start/end + duration, proof strip, seats left. The tray works from any grid, search, or rail. Pins persist across sessions.			Embed short-form video highlights (15-30s) , audience reaction clips , and verified text reviews on event pages, so the validation 88% currently seek on Google/YouTube/Instagram happens without leaving. Sourcing: post-event prompts to verified attendees, creator/artist trailers, moderated UGC clip uploads. Social integration: Instagram Reels from tagged creators, YouTube embeds, inline Google venue ratings — the exact channels users leave for today. Cold-start handled: new/niche events fall back to artist/venue reputation, similar-event reviews, editorial previews. Event-level and independent — works no matter how the user arrived.	
54% no side-by-side = #1 pain · Q7	50% want budget+date+distance · Q10	83% leave BMS to decide · Q6	88% need reviews/trailers · Q8	33% want video + verified reviews · Q12

THE COMBINED COVERAGE

Between them, these two address the pain cited by **54% (Q7 comparison)**, **50% (Q10 filters)** and **88% (Q8 validation)** — the loudest signals in the survey. They hit exactly the stage (Comparison → Shortlist) where the **steepest 46% funnel drop** happens, ship as one coherent flow, and leave the 50% who already know what they want completely undisturbed.

13

Trade-off Analysis

No solution is free. Here's what each one buys us, what it costs, and the risks worth keeping an eye on.

Help Me Pick Smart Filters + Compare Tray	Validation Proof Layer In-app proof
Optimizes: Decision speed and in-app retention. A journey that takes 4+ screens and 2 external apps collapses to filter → pin → compare, and cross-category comparison becomes possible. Sacrifices: The simplicity of the linear flow. Net-new surface to maintain — softened by being fully opt-in. Also costs: Discoverability, precisely because it's opt-in. The 3-bounce nudge is the hedge; entry-point adoption is the first thing to instrument. Key risk: Thin result sets read as "app is empty." Needs graceful relaxation with messaging. Build risk: Data availability (geocoding, end times, pre-checkout fee logic), not UI — that's what pushes effort to ~3 months.	Optimizes: Booking confidence for unfamiliar events — the 88% who won't book without proof. Especially valuable for live events (₹756 Cr). Compounds: Makes the compare view credible. Compressed into a column as rating + clip count. Works for users who never touch Help Me Pick. Sacrifices: Content freshness and operational simplicity — needs a UGC pipeline, moderation, stale-review management. Key risk: Cold-start for new/niche events with zero reviews. Mitigation (artist/venue reputation, similar-event reviews) needs careful calibration.

THE SELECTION LOGIC, IN ONE LINE

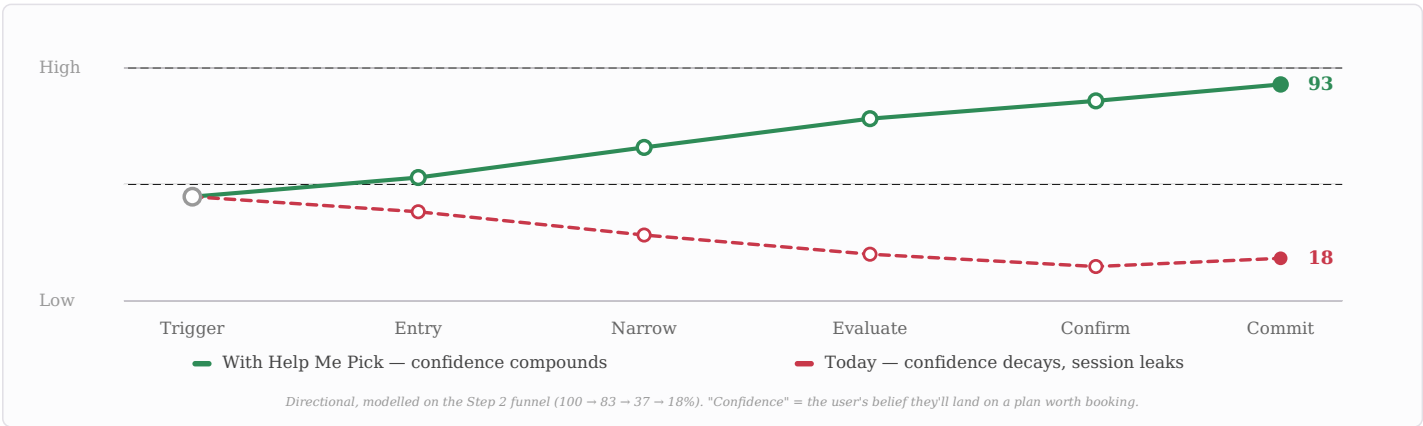
Help Me Pick solves "*I can't evaluate my options*"; Validation Proof Layer solves "*I can't tell if it's worth it.*" Together they close both sides of the comparison gap behind the 46% drop — as an opt-in path, so the 50% who already know what they want lose nothing.

14 Experience Flow

The full journey for the **Undecided Explorer**, the archetype we designed around. Each phase lays out what happens **today** next to the **design response**. Phases 1 and 6 are deliberately unchanged — we're not competing for the trigger moment, and the last mile already works.

Phase	Goal	Today	Design response
01 · Trigger Off-app	Decide whether tonight is worth leaving the house for.	Intent forms entirely off-platform. BMS only enters once a title's chosen.	Unchanged, on purpose. We win the moment right after the trigger, not the trigger itself.
02 · Entry Modified	See whether the app can narrow this down.	One door in. Category grids assume you know the title. –17% here.	A "Help me pick" card on home beside the untouched catalogue. Bounce off 3+ listings → dismissible nudge.
03 · Narrow New	Cut hundreds of listings to a handful that fit tonight.	No combined filter — budget, date, distance live in different places. 50% asked for this.	Five inputs, one screen, every field pre-filled. Results button live from frame one; chips stay editable.
04 · Evaluate New	Work out which of these is the better plan.	Every listing is its own page; comparison from memory. 54% named this the #1 pain — steepest 46% drop.	Category-agnostic Compare Tray — all-in price/person, distance + travel, duration, proof strip, seats left. Max 4 pins, 3 columns.
05 · Confirm New	Be sure it's worth the money before committing.	Leaves for Google, YouTube, Instagram. 88% need outside proof.	Validation drawer opens over the comparison , never away from it. Pins survive dismissal; cold-start falls back to reputation.
06 · Commit Existing	Lock the seats and get on with the evening.	This part already works fine. Only 18% of sessions ever reach here.	Untouched. Compare view hands off to the existing seat-map flow, event pre-selected. One addition: a post-event review prompt.

CONFIDENCE ACROSS THE SIX PHASES — TODAY VS. THE REDESIGN

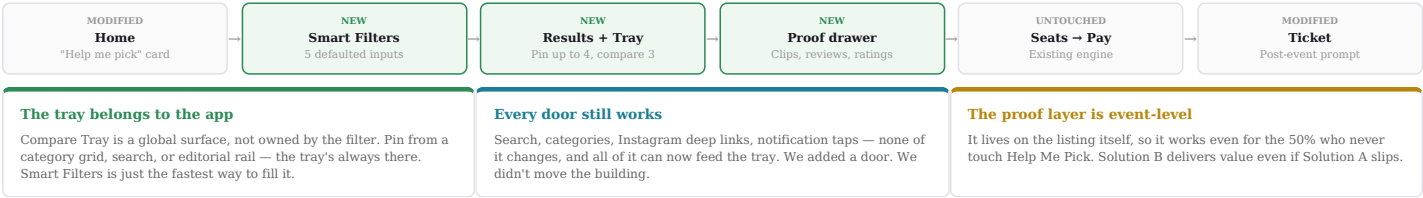


WHERE THE SOCIAL COORDINATOR DIVERGES

Same six phases, plus one loop. At **Narrow** she sets "Who with: group of 3–6", capping per-person budget and filtering venues that can't seat six. At **Evaluate** she screenshots the compare view into WhatsApp (in-app group voting is out of scope for v1). Persistent pins keep her from dropping out — the plan can stall for six hours and pick back up from the same tray. That screenshot is the instrumented signal telling us Group Plan & Vote has earned its Phase-2 slot.

15 How It Fits the Broader App

Three new screens, one modified home screen, and nothing removed. The new flow is a **parallel door** into the existing booking engine, not a replacement.



16 Product Requirements

Product	Help Me Pick + Validation Proof Layer	Version	v1.0 — MVP definition
Platform	iOS + Android (mobile-first; web parity Phase 3)	Status	Proposed — pending design review
Evidence base	Survey n=24 · app-review mining · competitive teardown	Dated	July 2026

16.2 · USERS

Role	Who	Job to be done	What this release owes them
Primary	The Undecided Explorer ≈21%	Find a plan worth leaving the house for, without knowing what she wants first.	A surface that helps her decide. Success = she never opens Instagram mid-session.
Primary	Validation & Budget Seeker ≈17%	Be certain an unfamiliar booking is worth the money before paying.	Proof in-app, and honest all-in pricing before checkout — not after.
Secondary	The Social Coordinator 2–6 outings	Get the group to agree and lock it in before the plan stalls.	Per-person budgets, group-size filtering, pins that survive a

			six-hour delay. Full voting is Phase 2.
Anti-persona	The Decided Booker ≈50%	Book the thing already chosen, fast.	Nothing. This release must be invisible to him. His path is a guardrail, not a target.

16.3 · GOALS

1	Move discovery-led session-to-booking conversion from 18% → 32% .
2	Keep evaluation in-app — cut mid-session exits to Instagram, Google and YouTube.
3	Make cross-category comparison possible: a movie against a comedy show against a workshop.
4	Ship comparison and validation as separable features, each defensible alone.
5	Leave the Decided Booker's path measurably unchanged.

16.4 · SOLUTION IN THREE STATES

Narrow · Smart Filters Five inputs on one screen — plan type, when, how far, budget, who with — all pre-filled. Reduces the set.	Evaluate · Compare Tray Pin up to 4, compare 3 columns on a category-agnostic spine. Evaluates the set. Global surface.	Confirm · Proof Layer Clips, reviews, ratings on every listing, expandable in place. Confirms the choice.
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17 Scope

P0 is the smallest build that closes the loop end to end. If P0 doesn't move conversion, nothing in P1 rescues it — that's the point of drawing the line where we did.

P0 MVP — ship the loop ~3 months ▶ Help me pick entry card on home ▶ Five-input filter panel, all defaulted, single screen ▶ Sticky editable filter chip bar ▶ Rule-based fit ranking ▶ Compare Tray: pin 4, 3 columns, global ▶ Comparison spine: all-in price/person, distance + travel, duration, proof strip, seats left ▶ Pins persist across sessions ▶ Proof drawer: verified reviews, clips, venue rating ▶ Graceful relaxation when thin ▶ Post-event review prompt ▶ Full instrumentation + guardrail dashboard	P1 Next — once P0 proves out +2-3 months ▶ Pin top 3 for me — one-top shortlist ▶ Behavioural nudge: 3+ bounces → "Comparing a few?" ▶ UGC clip upload with moderation ▶ Instagram Reel & YouTube embeds ▶ Cold-start inference: artist/venue reputation ▶ Share the compare view ▶ Web parity for filter and tray	P2 Later — earns its slot on data Unscheduled ▶ Group Plan & Vote — gated on P1 share-rate ▶ Hold My Seat — 12-24h lock ▶ Learned personalisation for ranking ▶ Worth-It Score indicator ▶ Commonly Booked Together bundling ▶ Vibe Browse mood taxonomy
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EDGE CASES — SPECIFIED, NOT DEFERRED

Case	Behaviour	Why it matters
Thin or zero results	Auto-relax the most restrictive facet and label it — "Nothing under ₹1,000 — here are 6 up to ₹1,400." Never a blank screen.	Tight filters on a Tuesday in a tier-2 city read as "the app is empty." Highest-frequency failure mode.
Pin goes stale	Outside filters → stays, flagged. Sells out → column greys, "sold out" badge, similar-option swap offered.	User judgment outranks a stated constraint; comparison must degrade gracefully.
Event has no proof	Fall back to artist/venue reputation and similar-event reviews. Every listing shows some signal.	Otherwise the proof layer quietly buries new and niche inventory.
Location denied	Fall back to last-used city, then a city picker. Distance reads "set location" not blank.	Distance is core to the spine; the flow can't hard-depend on a permission users may refuse.

DEPENDENCIES — THE REAL BUILD RISK

Dependency	What's needed	Risk if missing
Venue geo & event timing	Lat/long + travel-time for every venue; reliable duration/end time on every listing.	No distance/duration rows — guts the spine, breaks the time filter.
All-in price, pre-checkout	Convenience fees and taxes exposed at listing level, per person.	Comparison shows dishonest prices — worse than none.
Unified category schema	One shape across movies, live, sports, workshops; near-real-time seats-remaining.	Cross-category comparison impossible; collapses to within-category.
Verified-attendee reviews	Booking-to-review linkage + moderation queue.	Proof layer fills with unverified noise, loses credibility.

SCOPING HONESTY

The tray and filter panel are **straightforward UI**. What pushes this to ~3 months is the data work — geocoding, end times, pre-checkout fee logic, a unified schema. **If any of that slips, re-scope the release, not just delay it.** The fallback is a within-category v0 that ships the loop on movies alone, where the schema already exists.

18 User Stories & Acceptance Criteria

P0 only. Every story is testable — if the acceptance criteria pass, it ships.

US-01 · Entry

As an undecided user, I want an obvious way to say "help me pick" so I don't have to browse categories I haven't chosen yet.

ACCEPTED WHEN

- ✓ Entry card visible on home **without scrolling** on a 6.1" device
- ✓ Existing catalogue **unchanged in position and content**
- ✓ Entry is dismissible, doesn't reappear in the same session
- ✓ **No interstitial** or forced tutorial precedes the filter screen

US-02 · Narrow & refine

As a user with real-world constraints, I want to set budget, time, distance, category and group size in one place — and still change my mind after searching.

ACCEPTED WHEN

- ✓ All five inputs on **one scrollable screen** — no wizard
- ✓ Every input carries a working default; **Show plans enabled on load**
- ✓ Result count updates **within 400ms** of any change
- ✓ Budget interpreted **per person** and labelled
- ✓ Applied filters render as **sticky chips**; clearing one re-runs without losing scroll

US-03 · Pin & compare

As a user weighing options, I want to pin the interesting ones and see them side-by-side on the same rows so I can tell which is the better plan.

ACCEPTED WHEN

- ✓ Pin control on **every result card** and event page, across categories
- ✓ **4th pin is the max**; a 5th prompts a swap, never a silent drop
- ✓ **3 columns visible** without horizontal scroll on a 6.1" device
- ✓ All six spine rows populate, or show explicit "not available"
- ✓ Price displays **all-in, per person**, matching checkout
- ✓ Editing a filter **doesn't remove** a pinned column

US-04 · Confirm

As a user unsure about an unfamiliar event, I want proof in the app so I don't have to check Google.

ACCEPTED WHEN

- ✓ Proof opens as a **drawer over the comparison**; pins survive dismissal
- ✓ Drawer shows verified reviews, clips, venue rating
- ✓ Events with no proof show a **labelled fallback**, never empty
- ✓ First frame renders **within 1s** on 4G

US-05 · Commit

As a user who has decided, I want to book the winner directly from the comparison without retracing my steps.

ACCEPTED WHEN

- ✓ Each column has a **Book** action into the existing seat map
- ✓ The event is **pre-selected**; no re-search
- ✓ Abandoning checkout returns to the comparison with pins intact

19 Success Metrics

One north star, five primary metrics that explain movement in it, and guardrails protecting the half of the user base this release isn't meant for.

NORTH STAR

18% → 32% **Discovery-led session-to-booking conversion** — the share of sessions that start without a fixed choice and end in a BookMyShow booking. A 14-point lift, measured over a 90-day window post-rollout. The only metric that moves if, and only if, the comparison gap actually closes.

19.1 · PRIMARY METRICS

Metric	Baseline	Target	Why this one
Discovery-led conversion	18%	32%	The north star. Everything below explains a move in this number.
Mid-session external exit	83% leave (Q6)	<50%	Most direct read on whether evaluation happens in-app.
Compare → book rate	n/a — new	>40%	Of tray-opening sessions, how many end in a booking.
Filter → pin rate	n/a — new	>55%	Tests the handoff. High filter, low pin = irrelevant results.
Time open → booking	Unmeasured	<6 min	Discovery should feel easier. A faster decision = "lighter."

GUARDRAILS — THE DECIDED BOOKER MUST NOT PAY FOR THIS

Guardrail	Must hold	Action if breached
Median time-to-book, known-title	Within ±5% of baseline	Ship-blocker. Reduce home surface area.
Home p95 load time	No regression	Ship-blocker. Lazy-load the entry card.
Catalogue / search entry rate	No decline >3pp	Investigate cannibalisation.
Crash-free sessions	≥99.5%	Roll back tray, keep filter.
Checkout abandonment	No increase	All-in pricing may surface sticker shock early.

Honest all-in pricing might **reduce** short-term conversion by removing a surprise that currently helps convert. We accept that — the alternative is a comparison feature that lies.

20 Rollout & Risks

Four phases. The first is the least exciting and carries most of the risk — which is usually how it goes.

PHASE 0

Data first

Geocode venues, backfill end times, pull fees out of checkout into the listing.

Move on when 90% of live inventory has distance, duration and all-in price. Else build movies-only and say so.

PHASE 1

Dogfood, then 5%

Three metros, discovery-led only. Confirm events fire and watch ten people use the filter unaided.

Move on when no guardrail breached, filter~pin >40%, nobody abandons the filter.

PHASE 2

25% with control

Six weeks, held-out control, powered to detect a 5pp lift. Tells us whether the thesis holds.

Move on when conversion up ≥5pp and external exits down ≥15pp.

PHASE 3

Everyone, then P1

National rollout, web parity, then the P1 list — shortlist, nudge, UGC pipeline.

Hold the line: P2 stays shut until 90-day conversion holds above 28%.

Still open: Should default radius vary by city tier? Is 4 pins right, or does behaviour cluster at 2? Does "Who with" belong in the filter, or should group size be inferred? And do users actually trust an all-in price more than a lower headline?

21 Design Rationale

We're adding three screens to an app whose strength is a short, linear path. The real challenge is making it feel **lighter rather than heavier**, so every decision is named for the interaction pattern it uses and the friction it removes.

Core design decision	Why it reduces cognitive friction
Progressive Disclosure opt-in entry · tray hidden until first pin	Help Me Pick is a card, not a gate; the tray isn't on screen until something's pinned. The 50% who know what they want see zero additional UI.
Defaults Over Questions five inputs, all pre-filled	Every filter shows a working answer already — near me, tonight, any budget. Nobody's forced to declare constraints they haven't formed. Nothing has to be answered to see results.
In-Context Persistence editable chips · pins that survive	Filters stay visible and open in place. Pins survive filter edits, sell-outs, app restarts. Nothing the user sets ever gets taken away , so exploring costs nothing.
Single-Screen Matrix one spine · max 4 pins, 3 columns	Four event-page visits and two app switches collapse into one side-by-side view. The cap is deliberate: past four columns, people stop comparing and start scrolling.
Honest Numbers all-in price, per person, pre-checkout	Fees and taxes show at the listing, not sprung at checkout. Users can stop mentally padding every price they read.
Validation In Place proof drawer over the comparison	Clips, reviews, ratings open <i>on top of</i> the comparison. Checking worth becomes a glance instead of a detour, and the shortlist is still there when dismissed.
System-Side Recovery relaxation, not an empty state	Thin results → the system loosens the tightest filter and says so. Users never have to figure out which of their own filters is the problem.

- Rejected: **sequential wizard**
- Rejected: **filter-first home**
- Rejected: **unlimited pins**
- Rejected: **per-category compare templates**
- Rejected: **headline price + fee footnote**

THE CLAIM, AND HOW IT CAN BE FALSIFIED

Three screens got added, but *not a single step got added to any existing path*. All the new weight lands on the journey that was already failing — and even there it *replaces* effort: four screens and two apps collapse into **filter → compare → confirm**. The measurable version of "lighter" is median time from app open to booking, under six minutes. **If that number doesn't fall, the design didn't work — whatever conversion says.**

Go-to-Market, Growth & Monetization

22 Launch Plan

Discovery-led booking is a wedge, not a big-bang feature. It should launch wherever the problem is most acute and inventory is dense enough for comparison to mean something — one city, one segment, over a few weeks.

WHY NOW — THE MARKET IS MOVING TOWARD EXPERIENCES

India's live-events market is estimated at **₹13,000 Cr**, and spend is shifting toward experiences. BMS's own live-events revenue jumped **+66% to ₹756 Cr** in FY25 — the fastest-growing segment. This is exactly the inventory where discovery and comparison matter most: nobody needs help deciding on a movie they know, but they do need help picking between four unfamiliar Saturday-night options.

22.1 · WHERE TO LAUNCH — AND WHY NOT MUMBAI

Bengaluru — the pick

Highest concentration of the Undecided Explorer — young, high disposable income, a going-out culture across comedy, music, workshops and film. **Cross-category density is real here** — the one condition the compare tray depends on.

Mumbai / Delhi — later

Huge but movie-dominated and transactional — a Decided-Booker skew that would dilute the signal. **Phase-2 scale markets**, not where to learn.

Pune / Hyderabad — read-across

Similar profile, smaller scale. **The validation cohort** — if the loop transfers here, it generalizes. If it only works in Bengaluru, it's a local quirk.

LAUNCH MARKET · PHASE 1 — BENGALURU

Chosen on **fit, not size** — the densest overlap of discovery-led users and genuinely cross-category inventory. A win here means the feature works; a win in Mumbai could just mean movie volume. We launch to the **segment before the city** — discovery-led sessions inside Bengaluru, not all of it.

22.3 · FIRST FEW WEEKS — DRIVING ADOPTION

WEEKS 0-1

Seed & instrument

Live for 5% of Bengaluru discovery-led sessions. Analytics validated before any push.

Watch: events fire; no guardrail breach; ten moderated filter sessions.

WEEKS 2-3

Prime the proof layer

Post-event review prompts to recent attendees — proof must exist before users look for it.

Watch: review-submission rate; % of listings with ≥1 proof asset.

WEEKS 3-4

Activate segments

Re-engage lapsed weekend planners; target live-event browsers. Ramp to 25% with control.

Watch: entry tap rate >25%; filter-pin >55%.

WEEKS 5-6

Ignite the loop

Share-the-compare-view on; UGC clip prompts on. The growth loop starts turning.

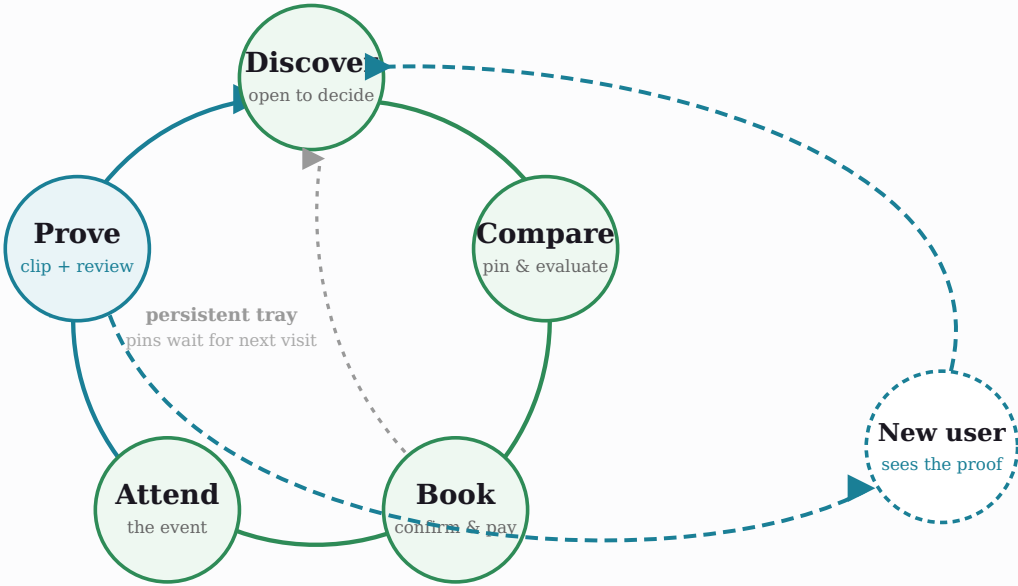
Watch: share rate; returning-tray sessions; first conversion read.

THE ANTI-LEVER: NO HEAVY DISCOUNTING

We're deliberately **not** buying adoption with coupons. A discount-acquired user is testing the coupon, not the feature — and the whole thesis is that **better decisions, not cheaper tickets**, drive conversion. Discounting would corrupt the read.

23 Growth & Behaviour Loop

A funnel ends at the booking. A loop **brings the user back and recruits the next one**. This design runs on two engines: a **retention loop** that pulls the same user back into discovery, and a **content flywheel** where every booking generates the proof that converts a stranger.



THE LOOP, IN PLAIN TERMS

Discover → Compare → Book → Attend → Prove → (back to Discover). After attending, the user is prompted for a clip or review at peak enthusiasm. That proof appears on the listing and in the compare tray, answering the next undecided user's "is it worth it?" — and the persistent tray lets an unfinished comparison pick back up next visit instead of starting from zero.

THE RE-ENTRY TRIGGERS — WHAT PULLS PEOPLE BACK

Trigger	Loop	Mechanism	Why it compounds
Leftover pins	Retention	Unbooked pins persist; a soft "still deciding on these 2?" brings the user back mid-decision.	Every abandoned comparison becomes a warm re-entry, not a lost session.

Post-event prompt	Flywheel	After attending, asked for a 15–30s clip or review — the moment of peak enthusiasm.	Converts a booking into an asset, at zero content cost.
Proof-driven discovery	Flywheel	That clip appears on the listing and in the tray, answering the next user's "is it worth it?".	More bookings → richer proof → the next cohort converts more easily.
Shared compare view	Flywheel	A coordinator shares the shortlist to WhatsApp; 3–6 open it, some not BMS-active.	Group planning becomes organic acquisition with no spend.
Weekend cadence	Retention	A Thu/Fri "what's on this weekend — pick in 2 minutes" push re-opens the loop.	Turns an occasional app into a weekly habit.

WHY THIS IS A MOAT, NOT JUST A LOOP

The content flywheel produces something a competitor can't copy by shipping the same UI: **a compounding library of verified-attendee proof, tied to bookings BMS already owns**. District could build a compare tray in a quarter. It can't conjure years of authentic clips and reviews. Every booking makes the next user's decision easier and the moat deeper.

24 Business Impact Model

What is an 18% → 32% conversion move actually worth? Built to be **read, not taken on faith**: real filings where they exist, labelled assumptions where they don't, and a sensitivity table so the conclusion holds even if any one number is wrong.

Anchored to FY25 filings Total income ₹1,869 Cr · Online ticketing ₹828 Cr · Live events ₹756 Cr · Net profit ₹192 Cr · YoY growth +30.7%	Reported scale 15M tickets/month → ≈18 Cr bookings/year · India live-events market ₹13,000 Cr	Stated assumptions (banded) Discovery-led ≈11% of bookings (sensitised 10–20%) · conversion 18%→32% · net take ₹45–80/booking · applies to discovery-led only
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24.1 · CONVERSION MECHANICS — THE DISCOVERY-LED SUBSET

Of BMS's ~18 Cr annual bookings, most come from Decided Bookers who already know their title — this feature doesn't touch them. It works only on the **discovery-led subset (≈11% of bookings)** that today converts at 18%.

Metric (discovery-led subset, base case)	At 18%	At 32%	Delta
Discovery-led bookings / yr	1.98 Cr	3.52 Cr	+1.54 Cr
Relative uplift within the subset	—	—	+78%
Incremental net revenue @ ₹45/booking	—	—	≈₹69 Cr

The +78% is assumption-free — it falls out of 32 ÷ 18 regardless of subset size. The rupee figure depends on two assumptions, so the next table varies both.

24.2 · SENSITIVITY — INCREMENTAL ANNUAL NET REVENUE (₹ CR)

Discovery share ↓ / Net take →	₹45 (conservative)	₹60 (base)	₹80 (live-heavy)
10% of bookings +1.40 Cr bookings	₹63 Cr	₹84 Cr	₹112 Cr
15% of bookings +2.10 Cr bookings	₹94 Cr	₹126 Cr	₹168 Cr
20% of bookings +2.80 Cr bookings	₹126 Cr	₹168 Cr	₹224 Cr

BASE CASE ≈₹69 Cr/yr 11% share · ₹45/booking	INCREMENTAL BOOKINGS +1.54 Cr/yr from the same traffic, no new users	RANGE ACROSS THE GRID ₹63–224 Cr every cell is positive
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READING THE MODEL HONESTLY

The base case adds roughly **₹69 Cr in incremental net revenue a year — about 8% of FY25 ticketing revenue** — from traffic BMS already has, with no increase in inventory or ad spend. Even the most conservative corner (₹63 Cr) clears a realistic build cost many times over, and the downside is bounded since the feature is opt-in. The question isn't whether this pays back — every cell says yes — it's how big, which the Bengaluru launch measures.

24.3 · SECOND-ORDER VALUE NOT IN THE TABLE

Retention & frequency The weekly loop lifts session frequency. A user who books monthly instead of quarterly is worth 3–4× more per year, compounding on the conversion lift.	Live-events mix shift Comparison and proof help most with unfamiliar, high-value live events — BMS's fastest-growing, highest-margin segment (₹756 Cr, +66% YoY).	First-party proof asset The content flywheel builds a review-and-clip library that improves ranking, cuts refunds, and can't be replicated by a fast-follower .
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25 Cohort-Based Rollout

Rollout happens by **cohort, not calendar**. Each stage opens only once the previous clears an evidence gate, so we scale a proven loop, never a hopeful one.

Cohort	Who	What we're testing	Gate to next cohort
C1 · Seed Wk 0–4	5% of Bengaluru discovery-led; live-event browsers first.	Does the loop turn at all? Instrumentation, guardrails, filter comprehension.	No guardrail breach · filter–pin >40% · clean qual sessions.
C2 · Prove Wk 4–10	25% of Bengaluru, held-out control. Lapsed planners activated.	Does it move the number? Powered A/B for ≥5pp lift and ≥15pp exit drop.	Conversion +≥5pp and exits –≥15pp, sustained 6 weeks.
C3 · Transfer Mo 3–5	Pune + Hyderabad. Full Bengaluru rollout in parallel.	Does it generalise, or was Bengaluru a local quirk?	Comparable lift in ≥1 transfer city · Bengaluru 90-day conversion ≥28%.
C4 · Scale Mo 5+	Mumbai, Delhi & metros; then national. Web parity. P1 features on.	Does it hold under BMS's most transactional, movie-heavy traffic?	National discovery-led conversion ≥28% before P2 scheduled.

STEP 5, IN ONE LINE

Launch narrow, in *Bengaluru*, where discovery-led demand and cross-category inventory are densest. Grow through a *two-engine loop*. Scale *cohort by cohort* against evidence gates — turning an 18% → 32% lift into an assumption-tested **₹63–224 Cr** of incremental annual revenue, from traffic BMS already has.

STEP 6

Metrics & Success Measurement

26 North Star Metric

Step 4 set a working north star — **discovery-led conversion, 18% → 32%**. That proves the loop *converts*, but a promotion-heavy ranking could hit the same target by pushing regretted bookings. Step 6 tightens the definition so the metric only moves if discovery is **both converting and actually good**.

NORTH STAR

16% → 28% Retained discovery-led conversion — the share of discovery-led sessions ending in a booking that **survives a 7-day regret window** (not cancelled or refunded; no recorded no-show). A ~12-point lift over 90 days against a held-out control. It ties **discovery quality** (the pick was good enough to stick) to **booking conversion** (a booking actually happened).

26.1 · WHY THIS DEFINITION, AND WHY THE NUMBER DROPPED

Quality is built into the count

A booking only counts once it sticks. A recommendation that converts then refunds nets to zero — the metric can't be inflated by aggressive promotion or a bad match.

16% not 18% — on purpose

Netting out the ~10% of discovery bookings that cancel/refund/no-show turns the \$19 raw funnel (18→32) into a **retained** 16→28. Same target, honestly discounted.

Measured against a control

Read as a lift over a held-out group (Cohort C2), never an absolute. That strips out seasonality and marketing spikes.

THE TEST IT MUST PASS

If retained discovery conversion rises while **refund and external-exit rates fall**, the feature is working as intended. If conversion rises while **refunds rise right along with it**, we're selling regret — and the north star, by design, won't reward that.

27 Supporting Metrics

Leading indicators move within a session or week and warn early whether the north star will follow. **Lagging** indicators confirm, weeks or quarters later, that the strategy held up.

27.1 · LEADING — PREDICTS THE NORTH STAR

Filter → pin rate	>55%	Results relevant enough to shortlist
Compare-tray open → book	>40%	Comparison resolves the decision
Mid-session external exit	<50%	Evaluation stays in-app (from 83%)
Top-6 reco acceptance	>35%	Purest discovery-quality signal
Cross-category discovery	+8pp	Consideration widening
Median time open → book	<6 min	The measurable form of "lighter"

27.2 · LAGGING — CONFIRMS THE STRATEGY

Retained-booking share	≥91%	Discovery quality holds at scale
Discovery 60-day repeat	+6pp	Trust earned; loop is turning
Categories / user / qtr	+0.4	Durable consideration expansion
Review + clip coverage	≥60%	Content flywheel maturing
Incremental rev vs control	₹63-224 Cr	The \$24 model is real
Discovery CSAT ("easier?")	≥4.2/5	The brief's promise, confirmed

HOW THEY CHAIN

Leading metrics are the **early-warning system** — a healthy filter-to-pin rate with weak reco-acceptance means the mechanic works but the ranking is off, usually fixable in a week. Lagging metrics are the **verdict**: repeat rate and incremental-vs-control decide whether Cohort C3 unlocks. We never scale on a leading signal alone.

28 Guardrail Metrics

Four ways a discovery surface can win the number and still lose the user: recommend badly, tilt for money, sell regret, or over-notify. Each gets a metric, a line it can't cross, and an action agreed **before** the incident.

Risk	Guardrail metric	Must hold	Action if breached
Low-quality recommendations	Pin-then-abandon rate · mismatch-attributed refunds · new/niche impression share	Abandon ≤35% · refunds ≤ baseline · niche share no decline	Recalibrate ranking & cold-start inference; the proof layer is surfacing the wrong things.
Promotional bias	Promoted slots in first 6 · promoted-vs-organic refund gap · take-rate-weighted relevance	≤1 in 6, labelled · gap ≤2pp · relevance no drop	Cap or pull promoted slots. Monetisation never outranks relevance — trust wins the tie.
Booking regret	Discovery refund/cancel rate vs decided-path · booked-then-refunded-within-24h	Discovery ≤ decided +2pp · 24h refunds ≤4%	Audit ranking + pricing honesty. A breach means regret is concentrating somewhere specific.
Notification fatigue	Push opt-out rate · nudges per user per week · nudge → open rate	Opt-out ≤ baseline +1pp · ≤2/week hard cap · open ≥8%	Throttle, then pause the nudge engine. A loop that burns its channel isn't a loop.

28.2 · PLATFORM GUARDRAILS — CARRIED FROM §19

Known-title time-to-book **within ±5%** Home p95 load **no regression** Catalogue / search entry **no decline >3pp** Crash-free sessions **≥99.5%** Checkout abandonment **no increase**

THE TRADE WE STATE OUT LOUD

Honest, all-in pricing before checkout might **lower** short-term conversion by removing a surprise that currently helps convert. We accept that: the alternative is a comparison feature that lies, and the promotional-bias and regret guardrails exist so we never buy the north star at the cost of the user's trust.

29 Event Tracking Specification

Every metric above traces to a fired event. Selected instrumentation across the funnel:

Event	Fires when	Feeds
DISCOVERY & COMPARE		
discovery_session_started	A discovery-led session begins.	North star denominator
filters_applied	Filter facet changed.	Filter→pin · relaxation
compare_tray_opened	Comparison tray is opened.	Compare→book · cross-category
BOOKING		

booking_completed	Payment confirmed.	North star · time-to-book · checkout
POST-BOOKING & QUALITY (REGRET WINDOW)		
booking_cancelled / _refunded	Cancel/refund within 7-day window.	Retained conversion · regret · promo gap
event_attended	Ticket scanned, or no refund by event date.	Retained-booking share
review_submitted / clip_uploaded	User contributes to the flywheel.	Catalogue coverage · CSAT
GROWTH LOOP & NOTIFICATIONS		
nudge_sent / _opened / _dismissed	P1 nudge lifecycle.	Nudge open rate · frequency cap
share_sent / referral_completed	User shares a pick / referral converts.	Loop recruitment

Coverage check: the north star needs only `discovery_session_started` + `booking_completed` - (`booking_cancelled` ∪ `booking_refunded`). Every \$28 guardrail maps to at least one event — no orphan metrics.

STEP 6, IN ONE LINE

Measure one thing that can't be faked — *retained discovery-led conversion, 16% → 28%* — surround it with leading signals that warn early and lagging signals that confirm it held, guard against the four ways a discovery surface can betray its user, and instrument it so **every number traces back to a fired event.**

Risks, Trade-offs & Constraints

30 Risk Assessment

Steps 1-6 made the case for this feature. This step is me trying to poke holes in it. Eight risks I'd plan around — two per area. Each gets a likelihood, an impact, what we're already doing, and the earliest warning signal. Every mitigation is genuinely in the plan.

Risk	Likely	Impact	What we're already doing about it	Earliest warning signal
ADOPTION & DEMAND				
R1 Nobody taps the entry point. Help Me Pick is a card people can ignore, not a gate.	Med	High	Sits above the fold (US-01); the P1 nudge catches people already comparing (3 bounces → "Comparing a few?"). C1 doesn't graduate unless people find and use the filter unaided.	Entry tap-through and filter→pin in Cohort C1.
R2 The discovery-led slice is smaller than ~11%. The revenue case leans on a number BMS doesn't publish.	Med	Low	The \$24 model runs across 10-20% and every cell still makes money — a smaller slice shrinks the prize without changing the decision. C2 hands us the real figure.	Actual discovery-led share from the C2 control read.
DATA & BUILD				
R3 The data underneath the tray isn't ready. Geocoding, end-times, honest pricing, one schema — the hard part.	High	High	Phase 0 is a gate, not a to-do: 90% of live inventory needs distance, duration and all-in price before any UI ships. Else we ship movies-only and say so out loud.	Share of live inventory carrying a complete spine.
R4 All-in pricing is hard to pull off. Fees vary by partner and only surface at checkout today.	Med	Med	Movies first, where we know the fee math, then onboard live venues in waves. \$28 accepts honest pricing might cost a little conversion — we keep it anyway.	All-in price coverage across inventory during Phase 0.
TRUST & QUALITY				
R5 Promotion quietly eats relevance. Pressure to sell more top slots is most likely to wreck the ranking people trust.	Med	High	The \$28 line: at most one promoted slot in the first six, labelled; if promoted listings refund >2pp more than organic, we pull them. Ad money doesn't outrank relevance.	Promoted share in the top six; promoted-vs-organic refund gap.
R6 Cold-start buries the long tail. A brand-new show has no proof, so it looks worse than a tired recurring one.	Med	Med	Fall back to artist/venue reputation and similar-event proof so nothing shows blank (\$17); watch niche impression share (\$28).	New/niche impression share against baseline.
BUSINESS & MARKET				
R7 A competitor copies the tray. District could ship a look-alike within a quarter.	High	Med	Fine — the tray was always the cheap half. What's hard to copy is the reviews-and-clips library (\$24): it only gets better with volume and can't be scraped overnight. We compete on the asset.	Competitor feature launches (watched externally).
R8 It doesn't travel past Bengaluru. A lift here doesn't prove a lift in Indore.	Med	High	This is the entire reason C3 exists — Pune and Hyderabad are the read-across. National rollout stays locked until the same lift shows up somewhere we didn't hand-pick.	Comparable conversion lift in ≥1 transfer city.

THE ONE THAT WOULD ACTUALLY SINK IT

If I had to bet on what kills this, it's **R3**. The rest bend without breaking — a smaller slice still pays, a copied UI loses to the proof library, an ignored entry point can be nudged. But a compare tray with missing distances and dishonest prices isn't a lighter version of the product; it's a worse product wearing the same clothes. That's why Phase 0 is a gate, and why the movies-only fallback is a real plan.

31 Strategic Trade-offs

\$13 weighed the two solutions against each other. This is the calls I made about the product as a whole. Every one is a real sacrifice, so I've written down what would make me change my mind.

Adoption quality over guaranteed reach

Help Me Pick is opt-in, and staying that way. The 50% who know what they want never see a new screen, and core trust stays intact. The cost: I can't force anyone in, so some discovery users walk straight past it.
We'd reconsider if *C1 tap-through comes in low and the nudge can't move it — at which point it's the no-gate decision that needs a second look.*

A booking that sticks over a bigger launch number

North star is retained conversion (16→28), not raw funnel (18→32). Netting out the ~10% that cancel gives a smaller, less impressive slide. I'll take it — a number you can't game is worth more than one you can.
We'd worry the moment *raw and retained start drifting apart — that gap is where "we sold someone something they regretted" hides.*

Depth on comparison over breadth of discovery

We put the whole build into the evaluation step instead of a recommendation feed or mood-browse surface. Research was clear: people weren't short on options; they were drowning in them with no way to line them up.
We'd revisit if *reco-acceptance runs strong while filter→pin stays weak — that would mean people want us to just tell them what to book.*

A tight surface over more features

Five inputs, four pins, three columns, one row shape. I said no to unlimited pins, per-category templates and custom columns on purpose. Each adds back the exact overload we're trying to remove.
We'd re-tune if *real usage clusters at two pins (simpler is better) or slams the four-pin cap constantly (the cap's wrong).*

One city, proven over national speed

Bengaluru first, gated, then transfer cities — no big-bang national launch. A discovery feature can drag down a checkout flow that already works, and I'm not willing to find that out at national scale.
We'd reopen sequencing if *a competitor ships the same loop nationally first — at that point the caution costs more than it saves.*

32 Constraints & Assumptions

Two lists, kept apart on purpose. **Constraints** are things I can't change — v1 is shaped around them. **Assumptions** are things I believe but haven't proven; each gets a confidence level and the specific way Bengaluru will show me I'm right or wrong.

32.1 · CONSTRAINTS — THE FIXED REALITIES V1 IS BUILT AROUND

Mobile screen real estate	Can't fit more than three readable columns on a phone — that's where the four-pin, three-visible-column cap comes from. Legibility, not performance.
The money path is off-limits	v1 books through today's seat map and checkout, untouched — also a guardrail (known-title time-to-book within ±5%). No new payment surface.

Partner data availability	Cross-category comparison needs geocoding, end-times and all-in fees to exist across partners. Where they don't, v1 falls back to movies-first.
Moderation capacity	A real UGC pipeline needs people and tooling. So P0 leans on verified-attendee reviews and editorial fallback; open clip upload waits for P1.
P0 is the smallest version	The smallest version that still closes the loop end to end. If something isn't load-bearing for that loop, it got pushed to P1 or P2.
The research is n=24	The survey points a direction; it doesn't prove a market. v1 treats every stated preference as a hypothesis that C1 behaviour gets to overrule.

32.2 · ASSUMPTIONS — WHAT I BELIEVE, AND HOW THE LAUNCH SETTLES IT

Assumption	Confidence	How we'll know if it's wrong	What we do if it breaks
Discovery-led is ~11% of bookings (bounded 10–20%)	Med	Measured straight off the C2 control, not survey shares.	The prize gets bigger or smaller, but \$24 stays positive even at 10%.
People trust an all-in price more than a lower headline with a fee footnote	Med	A/B all-in vs. headline-plus-footnote in C1/C2.	Rethink the display, but the price stays honest. A compare tool that lies isn't one I'll ship.
Discovery-led regret rate is ~10%	Med	Cancels, refunds and no-shows in the 7-day window.	North star re-baselines; the regret guardrail catches concentration.
The opt-in entry earns enough taps	Low	C1 tap-through and filter→pin, watched before we scale.	Push the entry harder, lean on the nudge — if still dead, revisit the no-gate call.
The lift generalises past Bengaluru	Med	C3 — Pune and Hyderabad — the deliberate read-across.	National rollout doesn't happen. The feature stays regional until it travels.
The comparison gap is the real bottleneck	High	Best-triangulated thing in the file: survey (54% can't compare, 83% leave), competitor teardown, and BMS's ~25% reco CTR all agree.	Load-bearing assumption. If external exits don't drop in C1/C2, this is what was wrong and everything downstream is back on the table.

STEP 7, IN ONE LINE

One risk could actually sink this — *the data under the tray* — and it's already fenced behind a Phase 0 gate with a movies-only backup written down. Everything else either bends without breaking or is a call I made on purpose and can defend. The constraints decide what v1 gets to be; the assumptions get settled in Bengaluru, shakiest ones first. **Judgment here isn't pretending there's no risk — it's being able to point at the one that matters and say why I'm carrying it.**